be made to strengthen the implementation of the Biological Diversity Act and provide support to the State Biodiversity Boards and at local level prepare Peoples Biodiversity Registers. Doha Climate Change Conference 2012.

The 18th session of the COP to the UNFCCC, that started on 26 November and concluded on 8 December 2012 in **DOHA**, Qatar has resulted in a set of decisions (clubbed together as **'Doha Climate Gateway'**) aimed at advancing the implementation of the UNFCCC and its Kyoto Protocol (KP). The key issues for the Doha conference were –

i. Amending the **KP** (Kyoto Protocol) to implement the second commitment period under the Protocol;
ii. Successfully concluding the work of the **BAP** (Bali Action Plan) within which there was urgent need for a clear path to climate finance; and
iii. Planning the work under the **DP** (Durban Platform) for enhanced action.

The Conference addressed all three issues and came out with a package which balanced the interests and obligations of various countries.

At the Doha Conference, the three issues of equity, technology-related IPRs, and unilateral measures raised by India resounded in the decisions. These outstanding or unresolved issues under the BAP are now part of the planned or continuing work of various bodies of the Convention. At Doha, India also ensured that no hasty decision was taken on aspects related to mitigation in agricultural sector at global level as agriculture is a sensitive sector for developing countries. The Conference has explicitly recognised that the action of Parties will be based on equity and CBDR including the need for equitable access to sustainable development. The Conference also recognised that issues relating to global peaking that could place a cap on emissions of developing countries and restrict their development space were controversial and best avoided at this stage of development. At the same time, in an effort to cater to the interest of all countries and come up with a balanced package, some elements of the package required compromise or deferral. In many cases, ambitious and strong demands were collectively made by developing countries, but in the act of balancing, countries were made to accept the mellowed down and subtle versions of their demands.